

ACTIVITY SOLUTION: USE PULL SYSTEM FOR GIVEN SITUATIONS



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I HAVE PROVIDED A FEW SITUATIONS WHERE YOU CAN IMPLEMENT A PULL SYSTEM. YOUR JOB IS TO UNDERSTAND THE SITUATION AND SELECT THE RIGHT ALTERNATIVE FROM THE GIVEN CHOICES THAT REFLECT THE CORRECT USE OF PULL SYSTEM.

ACTIVITY SOLUTION: SITUATION 01

YOU ARE SETTING UP THE STORAGE AREA FOR SUPPLIES OF FIRST AID MEDICINES IN YOUR ORGANIZATION. WHEN SETTING UP THE FIRST AID, YOU HAVE TO ENSURE THAT

- 1) THE STORAGE AREA DOESN'T RUN OUT OF MEDICINES AND**
- 2) MEDICINES ARE REPLACED BEFORE THEIR EXPIRY DATE**

AS A LEAN EXPERT, HOW WILL YOU EXECUTE THIS SITUATION USING THE PULL SYSTEM?

OPTION 01

YOU WILL USE LITTLE, LAMINATED CARDS (CALLED AS THE KANBAN CARDS) THAT SAY WHEN THEY SHOULD BE TRIGGERED. FOR EXAMPLE, WHEN THE COUGH SYRUP REACHES ONE-QUARTER FULL, THE COUGH SYRUP KANBAN IS PUT INTO A COFFEE CAN. SIMILARLY, WHEN MEDICINES ARE TWO MONTHS AWAY FROM THEIR EXPIRATION DATE, YOU USE ANOTHER KANBAN CARD TO REPLENISH THAT ITEM.

OPTION 02

YOU WILL SET UP A REGULAR REVIEW AND AUDIT MECHANISM OF ALL MEDICINES IN THE FIRST AID KIT. ON A TWO-MONTHLY BASIS, A MEMBER OF THE ORGANIZATION WILL REVIEW IF MEDICINES ARE EXPIRED OR HAVE BEEN RUN OUT.

ACTIVITY SOLUTION: SITUATION 02

YOUR ORGANIZATION HAS RECENTLY STARTED A BACK-OFFICE PROCESS. THIS BUSINESS PROCESS INVOLVES RESPONDING TO CUSTOMER EMAILS. IT'S A CRITICAL COMPONENT OF YOUR ORGANIZATION. THE EMAILS FROM YOUR CUSTOMERS ACCUMULATE IN A SHARED MAILBOX. THESE EMAILS NEED TO BE RESPONDED WITHIN 24 HOURS AND WITH 100% ACCURACY. HOW WILL YOU SET UP THIS PROCESS USING THE PULL SYSTEM?

OPTION 01

YOU WILL CREATE A PROCESS WHERE THE SUPERVISOR WILL ALLOCATE WORK TO HIS TEAM MEMBERS. FOR EXAMPLE, IF THE PROCESS RECEIVES 200 EMAILS AND THERE ARE 10 TEAM MEMBERS WORKING, THE SUPERVISOR WILL ALLOCATE 20 EMAILS PER TEAM MEMBER.

OPTION 02

YOU WILL CREATE A PROCESS WHERE EACH TEAM MEMBER IS ALLOWED TO PICK UP EMAILS FROM THE QUEUE AS SOON AS THEY FINISH RESPONDING TO THEIR CURRENT EMAIL. IN THIS CASE, THE SUPERVISOR DOESN'T ALLOCATE WORK, HE ONLY MONITORS THAT THE TEAM MEMBERS ARE PERFORMING AT THE RIGHT PACE AND FOLLOWING THE PROCESS WITH COMPLETE LEGITIMACY.